SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #77 · DEATH & GRIEF

“God took my loved one because He needed them more than I did.”

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Where it often comes from

Comforting sayings at funerals: “God needed another angel” or “God needed them more.” Searching for a reason behind a painful loss. Feeling that God chose against you. Anger or confusion about why someone was taken so soon. Trying to make sense of a death that seems senseless.

What Scripture teaches

This saying is often meant kindly, but Scripture does not teach it. God does not need anything; He gives life and breath to everyone. Death is called “the last enemy,” not a sign of God’s greed. Jesus wept at His friend’s grave. God holds our times in His hands, and we may not understand why a loved one died, but we can know that God did not take them because He needed them more than you. He grieves with you and will one day destroy death forever.

> *“The God who made the world and everything in it is the Lord of heaven and earth and does not live in temples made by human hands. Nor is He served by human hands, as if He needed anything, because He Himself gives everyone life and breath and everything else”* **(Acts 17:24–25)**.

Also see

> “The last enemy to be destroyed is death” **(1 Corinthians 15:26)**.

> “Jesus wept” **(John 11:35)**.

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” **(Psalm 147:3)**.

> “‘He will wipe away every tear from their eyes,’ and there will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the former things have passed away” **(Revelation 21:4)**.

Common self-statements

- God needed them more than I did.
- God chose to take them from me.
- God must not care about my pain.
- I wasn’t important enough to keep them.
- God wanted them in heaven, so He took them.
- I’m angry at God for taking them.

Common logical errors

- **Mind reading:** Assuming you know why God allowed the death.
- **Projection:** Picturing God as needy or selfish.
- **Personalization:** Feeling that God chose against you personally.
- **Accepting a saying without checking:** Treating a funeral phrase as Scripture.

Challenging questions

- Does God need anything, according to Acts 17:25?
- What does Scripture call death?
- How did Jesus respond to death at Lazarus' grave?
- Is this saying from the Bible or from well-meaning people?
- Can I bring my anger and confusion honestly to God?
- Do I need to know why, or can I trust God without knowing?
- What does God promise to do with death in the end?

Truth summary

> God did not take my loved one because He needed them more than I did. God needs nothing. Death is an enemy that Jesus will destroy. I may not understand why my loved one died, but I know God grieves with me, heals the brokenhearted, and will one day wipe away every tear.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Grief
- Death/Dying
- God, All Loving
- Sorrow
- Anger

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "God took my loved one because He needed them more than I did"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"God took my loved one because He needed them more than I did." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Does God need anything?
- ☐ What does Scripture call death?
- ☐ How did Jesus respond to death?
- ☐ Is this saying from Scripture or people?
- ☐ Can I bring my anger to God?
- ☐ Can I trust God without knowing why?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God does not need anything; He gives life.
- ☐ Death is an enemy that Jesus will destroy.
- ☐ Jesus weeps with those who grieve.
- ☐ God heals the brokenhearted.
- ☐ I can trust God without knowing why.
- ☐ God will wipe away every tear.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Acts 17:24–25**
  "The God who made the world and everything in it is the Lord of heaven and earth and does not live in temples made by human hands. Nor is He served by human hands, as if He needed anything, because He Himself gives everyone life and breath and everything else."
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 15:26**
  "The last enemy to be destroyed is death."
- [ ] **John 11:35**
  "Jesus wept."
- [ ] **Psalm 147:3**
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- [ ] **Revelation 21:4**
  "'He will wipe away every tear from their eyes,' and there will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the former things have passed away."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Honest grief journal:** Each day, write one honest feeling about my loss and one truth about God.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Psalm 147:3 becomes: "He heals **Sarah's** broken heart and binds up **her** wounds."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Grief" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Write a letter to God** honestly telling Him what you feel about your loss, including anger.
- ☐ **Read 1 Corinthians 15:50–57,** and write what God will do with death.
- ☐ **Gently tell someone who uses this saying** what you have learned, if it helps you.
- ☐ **Talk with a grief counselor or pastor** about your questions.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "God took my loved one because He needed them more than I did": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One honest prayer about my loss
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God took my loved one because He needed them more than I did.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I miss my loved one so much. Help me reject the idea that You took them because You needed them more than I did. Thank You that You need nothing, that You grieve with me, and that You will destroy death forever. Heal my broken heart. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.